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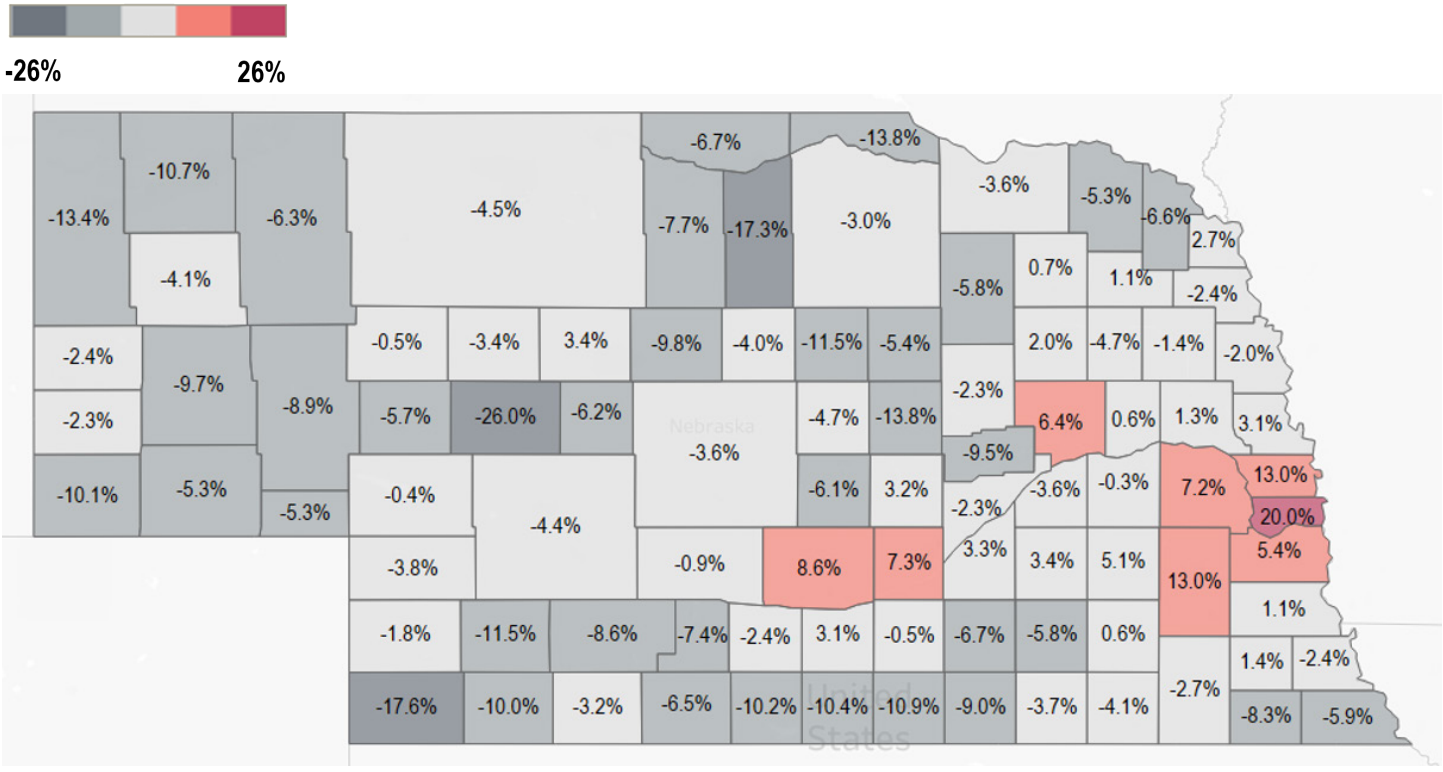
# POPULATION PROJECTIONS FOR NEBRASKA COUNTIES 2020 TO 2050

The 2020 Census, the official count of every person in the United States, placed the population of Nebraska at 1,961,504. Over the decade 2010 to 2020, the state grew 7.4%, see Figure 1. However, population growth was uneven statewide, as 69 counties lost population while areas including Omaha, Lincoln, Grand Island, Kearney, and Columbus grew at stronger rates than previously projected (UNO CPAR, 2015).

The release of the 2020 Census data provides the most accurate data to update population projections; however, not all data has been released at this time. Nonetheless, existing data on the fundamental aspects of population change, natural change and migration, are available. Moreover with aggregate population data for 2020, we can best fit a model of population change that reflects past dynamics. Nonetheless, all population projections should be viewed and applied with a great deal of caution as all projections are based on assumptions that may or may not occur. Moreover, as the time horizon for the projections increase, the likelihood of their accuracy decreases.

**Figure 1: Since 2010, Nebraska's population has increased 7.4% but 69 counties have lost population**

*Percent change in population 2010 – 2020 | 2020 total population = 1,961,504*




Source: 2010 and 2020 Census, U.S. Census Bureau

The table provided includes Decennial Census counts for Nebraska Counties in 1990, 2000, 2010, and 2020. Projections for the total population by county are provided for 2030, 2040, and 2050.

In contrast to past projections made by UNO CPAR, we apply the "regional rivalry" model developed by Hauer (2019) provided by the NASA Socioeconomic Data and Applications Center. The regional rivalry model was evaluated against five other models including available projections from UNO CPAR. The regional rivalry model was adopted as it best fit the population change dynamics seen within the state, including low migration and positive natural change rate. This model also estimates growth steadily and conservatively compared to the other models evaluated, consistent with Nebraska's population dynamics over time.

**Table 1: Decennial Census counts for Nebraska Counties in 1990, 2000, 2010, and 2020 and projections for the total population by county for 2030, 2040, and 2050**

| County | 1990 Population | 2000 Population | 2010 Population | 2020 Population | 2030 Projected | 2040 Projected | 2050 Projected |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Adams | 29,625 | 31,151 | 31,364 | 31,205 | 29,997 | 28,143 | 25,936 |
| Antelope | 7,965 | 7,452 | 6,685 | 6,295 | 5,292 | 4,634 | 4,079 |
| Arthur | 462 | 444 | 460 | 434 | 420 | 401 | 391 |
| Banner | 852 | 819 | 690 | 674 | 959 | 979 | 982 |
| Blaine | 675 | 583 | 478 | 431 | 560 | 600 | 631 |
| Boone | 6,667 | 6,259 | 5,505 | 5,379 | 4,462 | 3,952 | 3,501 |
| BoxButte | 13,130 | 12,158 | 11,308 | 10,842 | 10,834 | 10,532 | 10,267 |
| Boyd | 2,835 | 2,438 | 2,099 | 1,810 | 1,670 | 1,418 | 1,219 |
| Brown | 3,657 | 3,525 | 3,145 | 2,903 | 2,279 | 1,881 | 1,560 |
| Buffalo | 37,447 | 42,259 | 46,102 | 50,084 | 54,376 | 56,982 | 58,981 |
| Burt | 7,868 | 7,791 | 6,858 | 6,722 | 5,505 | 4,815 | 4,208 |
| Butler | 8,601 | 8,767 | 8,395 | 8,369 | 6,873 | 6,023 | 5,225 |
| Cass | 21,318 | 24,334 | 25,241 | 26,598 | 24,575 | 23,071 | 21,036 |
| Cedar | 10,131 | 9,615 | 8,852 | 8,380 | 7,335 | 6,525 | 5,742 |
| Chase | 4,381 | 4,068 | 3,966 | 3,893 | 3,845 | 3,732 | 3,658 |
| Cherry | 6,307 | 6,148 | 5,713 | 5,455 | 5,690 | 5,584 | 5,514 |
| Cheyenne | 9,494 | 9,830 | 9,998 | 9,468 | 10,179 | 10,036 | 9,776 |
| Clay | 7,123 | 7,039 | 6,542 | 6,104 | 5,484 | 4,862 | 4,291 |
| Colfax | 9,139 | 10,441 | 10,515 | 10,582 | 10,368 | 10,344 | 10,410 |
| Cuming | 10,117 | 10,203 | 9,139 | 9,013 | 8,728 | 8,407 | 8,076 |
| Custer | 12,270 | 11,793 | 10,939 | 10,545 | 9,728 | 9,048 | 8,360 |
| Dakota | 16,742 | 20,253 | 21,006 | 21,582 | 18,962 | 17,652 | 16,360 |
| Dawes | 9,021 | 9,060 | 9,182 | 8,199 | 8,342 | 7,514 | 6,718 |
| Dawson | 19,940 | 24,365 | 24,326 | 24,111 | 21,277 | 19,408 | 17,658 |
| Deuel | 2,237 | 2,098 | 1,941 | 1,838 | 1,891 | 1,912 | 1,954 |
| Dixon | 6,143 | 6,339 | 6,000 | 5,606 | 4,926 | 4,262 | 3,645 |
| Dodge | 34,500 | 36,160 | 36,691 | 37,167 | 34,737 | 32,833 | 31,011 |
| Douglas | 416,444 | 463,585 | 517,110 | 584,526 | 615,383 | 643,724 | 660,606 |
| Dundy | 2,582 | 2,292 | 2,008 | 1,654 | 1,414 | 1,212 | 1,059 |
| Fillmore | 7,103 | 6,634 | 5,890 | 5,551 | 5,320 | 4,924 | 4,527 |
| Franklin | 3,938 | 3,574 | 3,225 | 2,889 | 2,592 | 2,259 | 1,942 |
| Frontier | 3,101 | 3,099 | 2,756 | 2,519 | 2,095 | 1,707 | 1,406 |
| Furnas | 5,553 | 5,324 | 4,959 | 4,636 | 4,312 | 3,997 | 3,744 |
| Gage | 22,794 | 22,993 | 22,311 | 21,704 | 19,290 | 17,205 | 15,125 |
| Garden | 2,460 | 2,292 | 2,057 | 1,874 | 1,498 | 1,252 | 1,039 |
| Garfield | 2,141 | 1,902 | 2,049 | 1,813 | 1,922 | 1,846 | 1,780 |

| County | 1990 Population | 2000 Population | 2010 Population | 2020 Population | 2030 Projected | 2040 Projected | 2050 Projected |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Gosper | 1,928 | 2,143 | 2,044 | 1,893 | 1,755 | 1,673 | 1,641 |
| Grant | 769 | 747 | 614 | 611 | 639 | 630 | 612 |
| Greeley | 3,006 | 2,714 | 2,538 | 2,188 | 1,931 | 1,646 | 1,396 |
| Hall | 48,925 | 53,534 | 58,607 | 62,895 | 66,348 | 68,881 | 70,904 |
| Hamilton | 8,862 | 9,403 | 9,124 | 9,429 | 8,791 | 8,358 | 7,875 |
| Harlan | 3,810 | 3,786 | 3,423 | 3,073 | 3,296 | 3,095 | 2,950 |
| Hayes | 1,222 | 1,068 | 967 | 856 | 723 | 560 | 419 |
| Hitchcock | 3,750 | 3,111 | 2,908 | 2,616 | 2,608 | 2,464 | 2,400 |
| Holt | 12,599 | 11,551 | 10,435 | 10,127 | 8,931 | 8,067 | 7,369 |
| Hooker | 793 | 783 | 736 | 711 | 746 | 740 | 712 |
| Howard | 6,057 | 6,567 | 6,274 | 6,475 | 6,255 | 6,046 | 5,768 |
| Jefferson | 8,759 | 8,333 | 7,547 | 7,240 | 6,375 | 5,805 | 5,386 |
| Johnson | 4,673 | 4,488 | 5,217 | 5,290 | 4,903 | 4,801 | 4,744 |
| Kearney | 6,629 | 6,882 | 6,489 | 6,688 | 6,520 | 6,442 | 6,383 |
| Keith | 8,584 | 8,875 | 8,368 | 8,335 | 7,017 | 6,318 | 5,771 |
| KeyaPaha | 1,029 | 983 | 824 | 769 | 679 | 591 | 514 |
| Kimball | 4,108 | 4,089 | 3,821 | 3,434 | 3,222 | 2,920 | 2,689 |
| Knox | 9,564 | 9,374 | 8,701 | 8,391 | 7,467 | 6,787 | 6,233 |
| Lancaster | 213,641 | 250,291 | 285,407 | 322,608 | 352,368 | 375,268 | 393,993 |
| Lincoln | 32,508 | 34,632 | 36,288 | 34,676 | 31,722 | 28,521 | 25,688 |
| Logan | 878 | 774 | 763 | 716 | 724 | 681 | 643 |
| Loup | 683 | 712 | 632 | 607 | 427 | 319 | 243 |
| Madison | 32,655 | 35,226 | 34,876 | 35,585 | 33,090 | 30,952 | 28,591 |
| McPherson | 546 | 533 | 539 | 399 | 382 | 308 | 254 |
| Merrick | 8,049 | 8,204 | 7,845 | 7,668 | 7,023 | 6,425 | 5,779 |
| Morrill | 5,423 | 5,440 | 5,042 | 4,555 | 4,423 | 4,239 | 4,127 |
| Nance | 4,275 | 4,038 | 3,735 | 3,380 | 3,111 | 2,801 | 2,508 |
| Nemaha | 7,980 | 7,576 | 7,248 | 7,074 | 6,459 | 5,901 | 5,517 |
| Nuckolls | 5,786 | 5,057 | 4,500 | 4,095 | 3,604 | 3,182 | 2,780 |
| Otoe | 14,252 | 15,396 | 15,740 | 15,912 | 15,506 | 14,925 | 14,277 |
| Pawnee | 3,317 | 3,087 | 2,773 | 2,544 | 2,329 | 2,168 | 2,056 |
| Perkins | 3,367 | 3,200 | 2,970 | 2,858 | 2,499 | 2,182 | 1,911 |
| Phelps | 9,715 | 9,747 | 9,188 | 8,968 | 8,795 | 8,411 | 7,998 |
| Pierce | 7,827 | 7,857 | 7,266 | 7,317 | 6,775 | 6,453 | 6,056 |
| Platte | 29,820 | 31,662 | 32,237 | 34,296 | 32,335 | 31,966 | 31,796 |
| Polk | 5,668 | 5,639 | 5,406 | 5,214 | 4,740 | 4,467 | 4,251 |
| Red Willow | 11,705 | 11,450 | 11,055 | 10,702 | 9,692 | 8,910 | 8,217 |
| Richardson | 9,937 | 9,531 | 8,363 | 7,871 | 6,829 | 5,985 | 5,242 |

| County | 1990 Population | 2000 Population | 2010 Population | 2020 Population | 2030 Projected | 2040 Projected | 2050 Projected |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Rock | 2,019 | 1,756 | 1,526 | 1,262 | 968 | 753 | 608 |
| Saline | 12,715 | 13,843 | 14,200 | 14,292 | 14,543 | 14,473 | 14,613 |
| Sarpy | 102,583 | 122,595 | 158,840 | 190,604 | 213,311 | 232,217 | 245,861 |
| Saunders | 18,285 | 19,830 | 20,780 | 22,278 | 19,835 | 18,456 | 16,599 |
| Scotts Bluff | 36,025 | 36,951 | 36,970 | 36,084 | 32,782 | 29,995 | 27,704 |
| Seward | 15,450 | 16,496 | 16,750 | 17,609 | 16,432 | 15,491 | 14,422 |
| Sheridan | 6,750 | 6,198 | 5,469 | 5,127 | 4,416 | 3,928 | 3,575 |
| Sherman | 3,718 | 3,318 | 3,152 | 2,959 | 2,554 | 2,168 | 1,818 |
| Sioux | 1,549 | 1,475 | 1,311 | 1,135 | 1,070 | 948 | 873 |
| Stanton | 6,244 | 6,455 | 6,129 | 5,842 | 4,797 | 4,002 | 3,258 |
| Thayer | 6,635 | 6,055 | 5,228 | 5,034 | 4,644 | 4,440 | 4,320 |
| Thomas | 851 | 729 | 647 | 669 | 696 | 691 | 695 |
| Thurston | 6,936 | 7,171 | 6,940 | 6,773 | 6,361 | 5,867 | 5,369 |
| Valley | 5,169 | 4,647 | 4,260 | 4,059 | 3,633 | 3,338 | 3,143 |
| Washington | 16,607 | 18,780 | 20,234 | 20,865 | 18,943 | 17,437 | 15,659 |
| Wayne | 9,364 | 9,851 | 9,595 | 9,697 | 9,650 | 9,244 | 8,993 |
| Webster | 4,279 | 4,061 | 3,812 | 3,395 | 3,284 | 3,074 | 2,853 |
| Wheeler | 948 | 886 | 818 | 774 | 574 | 474 | 391 |
| York | 14,428 | 14,598 | 13,665 | 14,125 | 13,120 | 12,623 | 12,208 |
| **Nebraska** | **1,578,417** | **1,711,265** | **1,826,341** | **1,961,504** | **1,995,774** | **2,023,184** | **2,031,075** |

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